

D762

Special Education Law, Policies and Procedures

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A fourth grader with autism has made almost no progress on IEP goals for two years; the school says she received “some benefit.” Her family lives near the district office and her brother is in the gifted program. Under Endrew F., which statement is correct?

- A.** She should receive the gifted program services her brother receives.
- B.** The school must provide the best possible program.
- C.** Any benefit, however small, meets FAPE.
- D.** The IEP must be reasonably calculated for progress appropriate to her circumstances, so minimal benefit is not enough.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A second grader with passing grades struggles with reading, and his teacher has noted signs of dyslexia since fall. His parents work night shifts and have not asked for an evaluation. The school has a new reading series. What does Child Find require?

- A.** The school must seek consent to evaluate because it suspects a disability, even without a parent request.
- B.** No evaluation, because he has passing grades.
- C.** Give the new reading series a full year before any action.
- D.** The school must wait for the parents to request an evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A seventh grader with type 1 diabetes earns As and Bs and needs to check blood sugar and eat snacks in class. His father is a pharmacist and he plays in the jazz band. Which plan most likely fits?

- A.** No plan, because students with good grades never qualify.
- B.** An IEP under Other Health Impairment.
- C.** A plan written by his father as a pharmacist.
- D.** A Section 504 plan with health accommodations.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student with ADHD is failing reading and writing and needs direct instruction in written expression. Which plan fits better?

- A.** A 504 plan, because ADHD is always a 504 condition.
- B.** An IEP under IDEA, likely under Other Health Impairment or Specific Learning Disability.
- C.** No plan until a medical doctor confirms the grades.
- D.** A 504 plan with extended time only.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A parent signed consent for her son's initial evaluation in October. In December, the team finds him eligible and has an IEP ready. The meeting is held in the school library and the principal attends. What must happen before services begin?

- A.** Nothing; the October consent covers services.
- B.** The principal may consent in place of the parent.
- C.** The school may begin services and ask for consent later.
- D.** The school must get the parent's separate written consent for the initial provision of services.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A parent refuses consent for the initial provision of special education services. What may the school do?

- A.** Remove the child from school.
- B.** Not provide services and not use due process to override; it is not in violation of FAPE for that child.
- C.** File for due process to force services.
- D.** Provide services anyway because the child is eligible.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A tenth grader with a learning disability brings a knife to school. He has perfect attendance and made the honor roll last term, and the team determines the behavior was not a manifestation of his disability. What may the school do?

- A. Place him in an interim alternative educational setting for up to 45 school days while continuing services.
- B. Reduce the removal because of his honor-roll record.
- C. Suspend him for up to 90 days with no services.
- D. Nothing, because students with IEPs cannot be disciplined.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student with an IEP has been removed for 10 school days this year for minor rule violations. The school plans another 2-day suspension for a new minor incident. Which is true?

- A. Only the first 10 days needed services.
- B. The school may never suspend beyond 10 days.
- C. Beginning on the 11th day of removal, the school must provide services, and it must decide whether the pattern is a change of placement.
- D. Nothing changes until 45 days of removal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A parent emails a request to see her daughter's special education file two weeks before the annual IEP meeting. The case manager is on a busy testing schedule and the district is updating its computer system. What is required?

- A. Allow access only with a court order.
- B. Wait until the computer update is done, even if after the meeting.
- C. Let her inspect the records without unnecessary delay and before the IEP meeting, and no later than 45 days.
- D. Deny access because the file belongs to the school.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A special education teacher learns that a student has not received the 60 minutes of weekly speech services in his IEP for six weeks because of staffing. A colleague who has taught for 25 years says to log the sessions anyway. The school is short two aides. What is the ethical action?

- A.** Log the sessions as delivered to avoid conflict.
- B.** Tell the parents the school is breaking the law and post it online.
- C.** Record accurately and alert the administrator in writing so missed services can be made up.
- D.** Follow the veteran colleague's advice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A parent signs consent for an initial evaluation on September 10. The state follows the federal 60-day timeline, and the school psychologist serves three buildings. By what date must the evaluation be completed?

- A.** December 10
- B.** November 9
- C.** Whenever the psychologist has time.
- D.** October 10

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student was last evaluated and found eligible on March 5, 2025. The parent and school have not agreed to waive a reevaluation. By when must the next reevaluation occur?

- A.** By March 5, 2028
- B.** Only if the parent requests one.
- C.** By March 5, 2030
- D.** By March 5, 2026

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A fourth grader with autism has made almost no progress on IEP goals for two years; the school says she received "some benefit." ~~Her family lives near the district office and her brother is in the gifted program.~~ Under Endrew F., which statement is correct?

Target word: FAPE standard **Decides:** Progress must be appropriate in light of circumstances, beyond minimal benefit.

A	Camouflage	The sibling detail does not decide the FAPE standard.
B	Absolute language	FAPE does not require maximizing potential.
C	Inverted operation	That is the standard Endrew F. rejected.
D	Correct	Endrew F. rejected a merely de minimis benefit standard.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A second grader with passing grades struggles with reading, and his teacher has noted signs of dyslexia since fall. His parents work night shifts and have not asked for an evaluation. ~~The school has a new reading series.~~ What does Child Find require?

Target word: school's duty **Decides:** The school suspects a disability.

A	Correct	Child Find puts the duty on the school to identify and evaluate.
B	Dropped element	Children advancing grade to grade can still have disabilities.
C	Camouflage	A curriculum change does not delay Child Find.
D	Inverted operation	The duty is on the school, not the parent.

3. Answer D Concept 3

A seventh grader with type 1 diabetes earns As and Bs and needs to check blood sugar and eat snacks in class. ~~His father is a pharmacist and he plays in the jazz band.~~ Which plan most likely fits?

Target word: 504 vs. IEP **Decides:** He needs accommodations, not specially designed instruction.

A	Absolute language	504 eligibility does not depend on grades.
B	Adjacent category	IDEA also requires a need for specially designed instruction, which he does not show.
C	Camouflage	The parent's job does not decide the plan type.
D	Correct	A substantial limit on a major life activity with no need for specialized instruction fits 504.

4. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A student with ADHD is failing reading and writing and needs direct instruction in written expression. Which plan fits better?

Target word: when IDEA is the right plan **Decides:** Need for specially designed instruction.

A	Absolute language	ADHD can qualify under either law depending on need.
B	Correct	A disability plus a need for specialized instruction qualifies under IDEA.
C	Adjacent category	Grades and instruction needs are school decisions, not medical ones.
D	Dropped element	Drops the need for direct instruction.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A parent signed consent for her son's initial evaluation in October. In December, the team finds him eligible and has an IEP ready. ~~The meeting is held in the school library and the principal attends.~~ What must happen before services begin?

Target word: consent for services **Decides:** Initial evaluation consent does not cover services.

A	Dropped element	Evaluation consent and service consent are different.
B	Camouflage	Administrators cannot give parental consent.
C	Inverted operation	Consent must come before services start.
D	Correct	IDEA requires separate informed consent before first providing services.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A parent refuses consent for the initial provision of special education services. What may the school do?

Target word: school options after refusal **Decides:** Schools cannot use due process to override refusal of initial services.

A	Absolute language	Refusing services does not affect the right to attend school.
B	Correct	IDEA bars overriding a refusal of initial services.
C	Confusion set	Due process can be used for initial evaluation disputes in some cases, not initial services.
D	Inverted operation	Services without consent violate the law.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A tenth grader with a learning disability brings a knife to school. ~~He has perfect attendance and made the honor roll last term,~~ and the team determines the behavior was not a manifestation of his disability. What may the school do?

Target word: special-circumstances removal **Decides:** Weapons allow an interim setting up to 45 school days.

A	Correct	Weapon incidents allow a 45-school-day interim placement; services continue.
B	Camouflage	Grades do not decide the legal option.
C	Wrong stem number	Wrong day count, and services must continue after 10 days.
D	Absolute language	Students with disabilities can be disciplined within IDEA limits.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A student with an IEP has been removed for 10 school days this year for minor rule violations. The school plans another 2-day suspension for a new minor incident. Which is true?

Target word: what changes after day 10 **Decides:** Beyond 10 days, services must be provided and change-of-placement rules apply.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses the rule: services are required after day 10.
B	Absolute language	Further removals are possible with services and required reviews.
C	Correct	After 10 cumulative days, services are required and pattern review applies.
D	Confusion set	45 days applies to weapons, drugs, and serious injury.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A parent emails a request to see her daughter's special education file two weeks before the annual IEP meeting. ~~The case manager is on a busy testing schedule and the district is updating its computer system.~~ What is required?

Target word: records access **Decides:** Parents may inspect records without unnecessary delay and before an IEP meeting.

A	Adjacent category	Court orders are a sharing exception for others, not a condition for parents.
B	Camouflage	System work does not suspend the parent's right.
C	Correct	IDEA and FERPA both give parents access, with IDEA requiring it before meetings.
D	Inverted operation	Parents have a right to inspect education records.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A special education teacher learns that a student has not received the 60 minutes of weekly speech services in his IEP for six weeks because of staffing. A colleague ~~who has taught for 25 years~~ says to log the sessions anyway. ~~The school is short two aides.~~ What is the ethical action?

Target word: CEC ethics **Decides:** Honest records and advocacy for required services.

A	Inverted operation	Falsifying records violates ethics and the student's rights.
B	Adjacent category	Parents should be informed, but public posting breaches confidentiality and skips proper channels.
C	Correct	Accurate data and advocacy through proper channels protect the student's rights.
D	Camouflage	Years of experience do not make falsifying records ethical.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A parent signs consent for an initial evaluation on September 10. The state follows the federal 60-day timeline, ~~and the school psychologist serves three buildings.~~ By what date must the evaluation be completed?

Target word: evaluation deadline **Decides:** 60 calendar days from September 10.

A	Wrong stem number	About 90 days, too late.
B	Correct	20 days left in September + 31 in October = 51; 9 more in November = 60.
C	Camouflage	Staff load does not extend the legal timeline.
D	Confusion set	That is about 30 days, the IEP-meeting timeline.

12. Answer A Concept 8 • transfer

A student was last evaluated and found eligible on March 5, 2025. The parent and school have not agreed to waive a reevaluation. By when must the next reevaluation occur?

Target word: reevaluation deadline **Decides:** At least once every 3 years.

A	Correct	Reevaluation is required at least every three years.
B	Dropped element	Drops the three-year requirement.
C	Wrong stem number	Five years exceeds the three-year limit.
D	Confusion set	One year is the annual IEP review, not the reevaluation.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	FAPE under Endrew F.	An IEP must be reasonably calculated to enable progress appropriate in light of the child's circumstances, with appropriately ambitious goals; more than minimal (de minimis) benefit, but not the best possible education.	Thinking FAPE means the best program available or any benefit at all.	A parent requests a costly program, or a school defends an IEP with tiny progress.
2	Child Find and zero reject	Schools must locate, identify, and evaluate all children suspected of having disabilities, including those in private schools, highly mobile, or advancing grade to grade, and may not exclude any eligible child.	Waiting for parents to ask, or assuming passing grades rule out a disability.	A school knows of signs of a disability but has not acted.
3	Section 504 vs. IDEA	IDEA serves students in 13 categories who need specially designed instruction; Section 504 covers any student with an impairment that substantially limits a major life activity, often through accommodations only.	Assuming every student with a diagnosis qualifies for an IEP.	A diagnosed student who is doing fine academically but needs accommodations.
4	Parental consent	Consent for initial evaluation is not consent for services; separate informed consent is needed before first providing services, and parents may revoke consent for services in writing.	Treating one signature as covering evaluation and services, or thinking a school can use due process to force initial services.	A parent signed one form and the team moves to the next step.
5	Discipline limits and special circumstances	Removals beyond 10 school days in a year trigger services and possible change-of-placement protections; for weapons, drugs, or serious bodily injury, schools may place a student in an interim setting for up to 45 school days regardless of manifestation.	Believing a student with an IEP can never be moved for a weapon, or can be suspended without limit.	A day count of removals or a weapon/drug/injury incident.
6	FERPA and education records	Parents may inspect their child's education records and schools must respond within 45 days (IDEA requires without unnecessary delay and before an IEP meeting); records are not shared without consent except under listed exceptions.	Sharing records with anyone who asks, or refusing a parent's request.	A parent asks to see files, or an outside party requests records.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
7	CEC ethical practice	Special educators act in the student's best interest, maintain honest data and confidentiality, and advocate through proper channels when services are not provided as required.	Going along with a practice that violates the IEP to keep peace with colleagues.	A colleague or administrator asks for a shortcut that affects a student's rights.
8	Key IDEA timelines	Initial evaluation within 60 days of consent (or state timeline), IEP meeting within 30 days of eligibility, IEP reviewed at least annually, reevaluation at least every 3 years unless waived.	Mixing up the annual review with the three-year reevaluation.	A date and a question about when something is due.

Course scope (public description): Special Education Law, Policies, and Procedures prepares special education teachers to practice within legal and ethical guidelines as they navigate the Special Education processes, stakeholder interactions, and other complex situations. This course provides an overview of the professional ethics and professional practice standards of the Council for Exceptional Children (CEC), which guides candidates to act in a professionally conscientious manner. Candidates will explore special education legal foundations and case laws to apply legal foundations and ethical practices in special education process compliance.